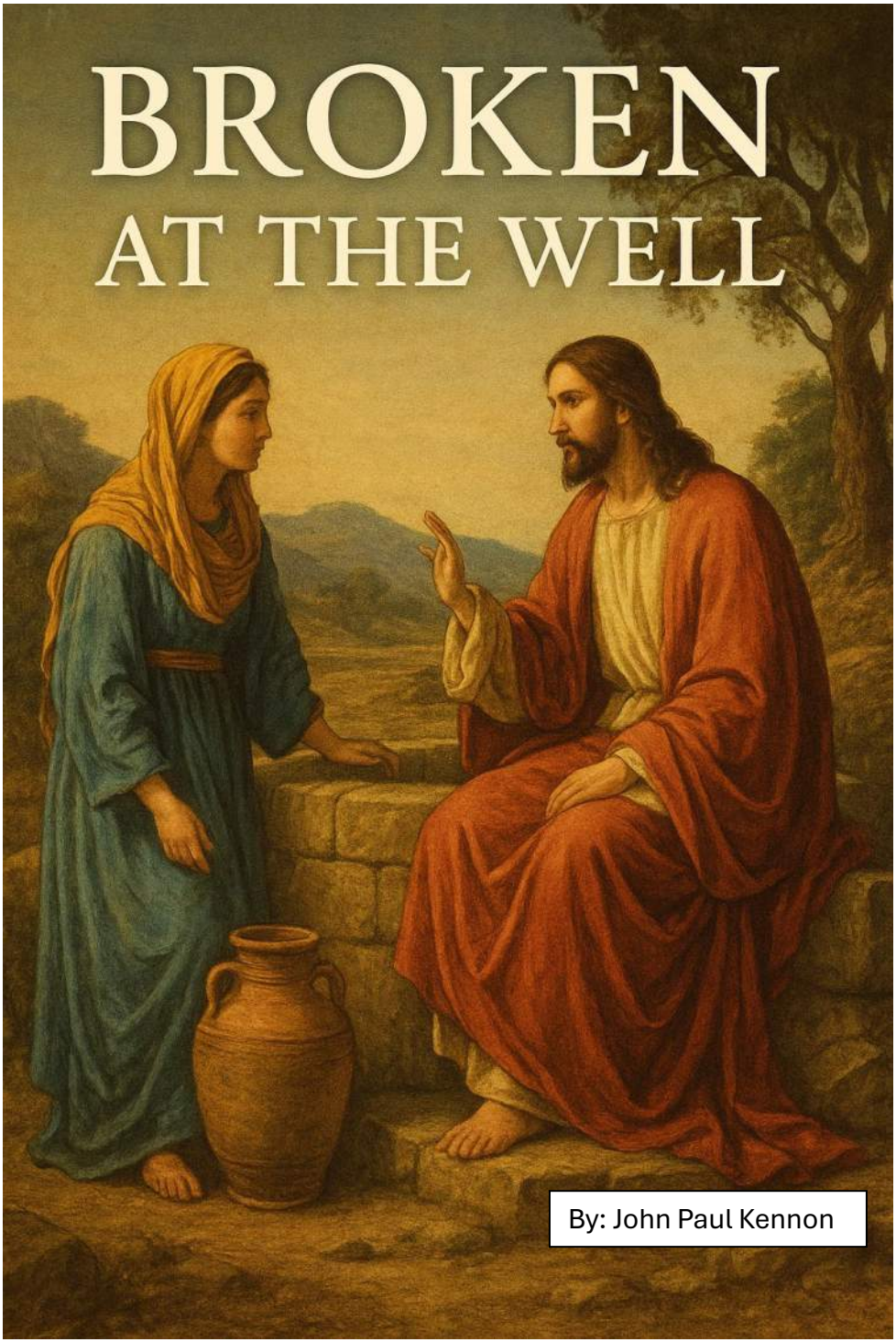

BROKEN
AT THE WELL
By: John Paul Kennon

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1) JESUS *MUST* GO BY SAMARIA — SCRIPTURE

Let's begin in **John 4:3–4**:

"He left Judaea, and departed again into Galilee. And He MUST needs go through Samaria."

Now, to us, that may sound like a simple travel route — a GPS note.
But to the Jewish mind, this was shocking.
Jews **avoided** Samaria at all costs.
Geographically, there were **two easier, cleaner routes**:

1. **The Jordan Valley Route** — longer, but safe and acceptable.
2. **The King's Highway Route** — used by rabbis who refused even to touch Samarian soil.

But John says Jesus **must** go through Samaria.
Not "should," not "might," not "it happened that way."

Must.

That word signals **divine necessity** — a heaven-level appointment.
A spiritual collision course.
A moment written into eternity long before Jacob ever dug that well.

Why must He go?

Because there is a woman who has lost her identity.
Because there is a region shaped by centuries of rebellion.
Because there is a well stained with history and heartache.
Because there is a conversation waiting that will alter the destiny of a city.
Because God is about to undo what kings destroyed.

Jesus didn't go *around* their pain —
He walked straight *into* it.

And that's why this story matters today.
Because the Jesus who "must needs go through Samaria"
still *must* go through **your** Samaria —
the places you avoid, the wounds you hide, the history you inherited.

“If Jesus *had* to go through Samaria, then we must understand **what Samaria was**. And for that, we turn to the history Josephus preserved.”

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2) BRIEF HISTORY FROM JOSEPHUS ON SAMARIA

To understand Samaria, you must see the centuries beneath its soil.

Josephus — the great Jewish historian — tells us that Samaria was not an ordinary city.
It was the **capital of rebellion**.

A. It began with Jeroboam

Jeroboam broke away from Jerusalem, built his own kingdom, and intentionally created an alternative religion:

- Golden calves at Dan and Bethel
- New priests not from the tribe of Levi
- A counterfeit altar
- A forbidden feast day
- A worship system designed to keep people away from the true presence of God

Josephus emphasizes that this move wasn't political — it was *spiritual sabotage*.
Jeroboam feared losing control, so he built a religion that kept God at a distance.

B. Samaria was built by Omri

Josephus writes that Omri purchased a hill and built a city "strongly fortified and beautiful," calling it *Samaria*.

It became:

- The royal palace
- The political headquarters
- The spiritual center of the northern rebellion

It was a city built without God.

C. Ahab enlarged the rebellion

Josephus says Ahab:

- Introduced Phoenician worship
- Married Jezebel
- Built a Baal temple
- Filled the land with false prophets
- Persecuted the prophets of God

Josephus records that wickedness in Ahab's day reached a level never seen before.

D. Assyrian destruction & resettlement

Josephus details how:

- Samaria was conquered
- Its people deported
- Foreign nations brought in
- Intermarriage was forced
- New religions were blended
- Priests were imported to teach a confused version of Mosaic law

This created a people:

- Mixed in blood
- Mixed in belief
- Mixed in identity

This is why Jews despised Samaritans — not simply because they were "different," but because they represented centuries of rebellion and compromise.

End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of Broken at the Well.

The full edition is being prepared for publication.

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